

Half-Dozen Pilots Lay Claim to Rank as Eau Claire's Best

(Sixth in a series. Clip and Save for use in voting for "Best of the Braves" contest to be run in this paper during the 1960 Northern League season.)

By CLELL BUZZELL

Who was the best manager in Eau Claire's 24 seasons of Northern League baseball?

It won't be easy for Eau Claire fans to pick among the 13 men piloting clubs here in voting for the key post of the all-time, all-star team during the 1960 season.

There's Joe Just, who batted 1.000 by winning pennants in both of his 1955 and 1956 seasons here.

There's Andy Cohen, who won a pennant and great popularity in three seasons here in 1948-49-50, when everybody went to the ball games.

THERE'S Johnny Mostil, who guided the club through five rugged seasons of 1933-37 and gained a reputation of developing players second to none.

Regis Track Team Engages Barron Today

Victors in two dual track meets last week, the Regis Ramblers will try for a third win against the Barron Bears here today at 3:30 p.m.

Coach Howard Kolstads trackmen have a record of two wins and one loss. They dropped their opener to Osseo early this month.

Barron, a 61-57 winner over Regis in a rain-soaked meet last year, isn't expected to be nearly as strong this spring. The Bears have only three lettermen and scored only four points in the River Falls Invitational last Friday.

Regis will be led by Pat Pavelski, who has scored eight firsts in three dual meets to date.

Pavelski is a threat to meet marks in both hurdles and the shot put. He's matched the high hurdle record of 16.1 seconds, bettered the low hurdle mark of 22.7 seconds, and topped the high jump mark of 5 feet 7 3/4 inches.

Barron's top trackmen are Bud Pond in the dashes, Larry Haugen in the pole vault, and Larry Greenwald in the high jump.

REGIS-BARRON MEET RECORDS

120-YARD HIGH HURDLES: Pat Watkins, Regis, 1959. T—16.1.

100-YARD DASH: Schleiss, Barron, 1952, and Dennis Kuchenmeister, 1956. T—10.6.

MEDLEY RELAY: Barron, 1958. T—4:06.1. (Vern Posquiter, Gary Wagonback, Jerry Harbough, Frank Hollister.)

440-YARD DASH: Schleiss, Barron, 1952. T—1:54.3.

880-YARD RUN: Dave Knutson, Regis, 1952. T—2:10.1.

MILE RUN: Dowd, Barron, 1956. T—4:54.3.

180-YARD LOW HURDLES: Pat Watkins, Regis, 1958 and 1959. T—22.7.



Maltzberger Mostil Adair Ryan

There's Rosy Ryan, who produced a playoff champion in 1941 and Eau Claire's first pennant-winner in 1942.

There's Bill Adair, who welded together a motley team in 1951 which swept to a pennant by a 12 1/2 - game margin.

There are several others. Ed Gharrity in 1938, Ivy Griffin in 1939-40, Joe Skurski in 1946, Hugh Wise in 1947, Rex Carr in 1953, Charley Root in 1954, Gordon Maltzberger in 1957-58, and Travis Jackson in 1959, who may gain support in the voting.

MOSTIL, although he never won a pennant, kept Eau Claire on the winning side of the ledger all but one of his five seasons here in Chappel Field days. His best mark was 67 wins and 52 losses for second place in 1936.

Old-timers will say that no Eau Claire manager since equalled Mostil in ability to take raw rookies and make them into ball players. His work with Stan Sperry and Hank Majeski is a good example.

Gharrity, Washington catcher for many seasons, had a rough year in his 1938 season here, finishing eighth with a 39-84 record.

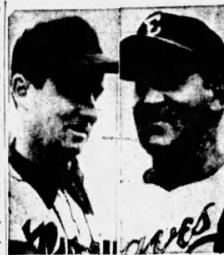
Griffin, managing in the last two years of the Chicago Cubs affiliation, brought Eau Claire home fourth in 1939 with a 56-60 mark and eighth in 1940 with 42-70. Lack of material hampered his efforts.

RYAN enjoyed two lush seasons in 1941-42 with a talent-loaded tieup with the Minneapolis Millers. His 1941 club placed fourth with 60-52 and won the playoffs. The 1942 Bears edged Winnipeg for Eau Claire's first pennant with an 81-41 record.

Skurski managed the 1946 return to baseball after World War II. His Milwaukee Brewers-backed team placed fourth with a 56-52 record.

Wise inaugurated Eau Claire's still-functioning affiliation with the Boston Milwaukee Braves, guiding the 1947 club to a fifth place finish with a 62-57 mark.

Cohen reigned at Carson Park in three "golden" years of 1948-49-50 which saw 280,000 fans storm the gates. His 1948 team placed third with 66-55, his 1949 team beat out



Just Cohen

Aberdeen for the pennant, and his 1950 club lost the championship by a half game on the final day of the season.

ADAIR LED the 1951 Bears to a 77-44 record and a 12-game pennant margin with an amazing second-half spurt. His 1952 club placed third with a 72-53 mark. Many observers rate Adair as tops in getting the most out of his teams.

Eau Claire hit bottom again with Carr in 1953, his talent-lacking team placing eighth with a 49-77 record.

Root stepped out of the big leagues to guide the 1954 Braves to a fourth-place finish with a 71-63 record.

Just brought the 1955 Braves home in front with a four-game margin and repeated in 1956 by five games. He took a place with Adair as an expert in putting together winning combinations.

Maltzberger, doing the testing of Milwaukee's prize rookie pitchers in 1957-58, placed third one year with a 70-55 mark and fifth the other with 65-56.

A travel-worn Jackson saw his 1959 crew skid to seventh place in the closing days of the season with a 55-68 record.

RYAN'S 1952 champions posted the best winning percentage of .664 with its 81-41 record. Just's 1955 pennant-winners also won 81 games but lost 43.

Five Eau Claire managers have guided the Northern League all-star game in the annual mid-season classic — Ryan in 1941, Cohen in 1948, Adair in 1952, Maltzberger in 1957 and Jackson in 1959.